Ethical Considerations in Research

- Understanding how ethics guides responsible research

What is Research Ethics?

- • Set of guidelines to ensure responsible and respectful research
- • Protects the dignity, rights, and welfare of research participants
- • Promotes integrity and transparency in research practices

Core Principles of Research Ethics

- 1. Respect for Persons – informed consent, autonomy
- 2. Beneficence – do good, avoid harm
- 3. Justice – fair treatment and distribution of research benefits
- 4. Confidentiality – protect participant data

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Informed Consent

- • Participants must be informed about the study’s purpose, risks, and benefits
- • Must voluntarily agree to participate
- • Consent must be documented

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Confidentiality and Anonymity

- • Personal data must be protected
- • Only authorized persons can access data
- • Use codes/numbers instead of names

Plagiarism and Integrity

- • Always give credit to original authors
- • Avoid fabrication or falsification of data
- • Maintain honesty in data collection and reporting

Ethical Review Boards (IRBs)

- • All research involving humans must be reviewed by an Ethics Committee or IRB
- • IRBs ensure that the research is ethical and participants are protected

Activity: Ethics Detective!

- 🕵️ Instructions:
- 1. Divide into groups of 3–4
- 2. Each group is given a short research scenario
- 3. Identify ethical issues in the scenario
- 4. Suggest how to make the study ethically correct
- 5. Present your findings to the class

Why This Matters for You

- • Ethics builds trust in science
- • Protects patients and participants
- • Essential for every healthcare professional
- • You will be involved in research throughout your career

Summary

Ethics = Respect + Responsibility + Honesty

Always get consent, protect data, avoid plagiarism

Ethics review is mandatory for human studies

Being ethical makes you a better doctor and researcher!

Case Scenario 1: No Consent, No Clarity

- Scenario:
- A BDS student surveys 20 patients about smoking habits without explaining the purpose or obtaining consent.

- Questions:
- • What ethical principles are violated?
- • What should the student have done before giving the survey?
- • How can patient autonomy be respected?

Case Scenario 2: Cut-Copy-Paste Project

- Scenario:
- Two students copy text from websites for their literature review without citations or rephrasing.

- Questions:
- • What is wrong with this research approach?
- • What does plagiarism mean, and why is it unethical?
- • How can the students correct this?

Case Scenario 3: A 'Hidden' Observation

- Scenario:
- A student records patients' facial expressions during injections without informing them or taking permission.

- Questions:
- • Which ethical principles are being ignored?
- • What could go wrong with such hidden observation?
- • How can this study be done ethically?

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